

Relay — Functional Use Cases

Test evidence for beta readiness. Every screenshot below was captured from **production** (relaystandby.com) during the walkthrough, not from a local build or a mock.

Build
Suite
Environment
Method
Data handling

master @ e875347

1547 passed / 1 skipped across 152 files · typecheck, lint and build clean

Production — Vercel, Aurora DSQL (us-east-1 / us-west-2), AWS KMS

One purpose-built circle, walked **end to end in sequence** rather than screen by screen: an owner with a name set, a verified partner who can sign in, an aunt marked emergency-code-only, a verified doctor, and a verifier who never accepted. The release below was genuinely started, genuinely confirmed, genuinely opened and genuinely reversed — each screenshot is the state the previous action produced.

All fixtures deleted afterwards; production returned to its baseline accounts with zero orphaned rows.

Coverage summary

REF	USE CASE	ACTOR	RESULT
UC-01	Know whether the vault could actually open	Owner	Pass
UC-02	Build the circle, and see who does not count	Owner	Pass
UC-03	Decide who can reach what	Owner	Pass
UC-04	Set the conditions	Owner	Pass
UC-05	Choose someone to help set it up	Owner	Pass
UC-06	Record how consent was obtained	Owner	Pass
UC-07	Accept a place in someone's plan	Contact	Pass
UC-08	Stand by, and see the shape of the grant	Recipient	Pass
UC-09	Ask them to open it	Recipient	Pass
UC-10	Answer a request for access	Owner	Pass
UC-11	Start a release yourself	Owner	Pass
UC-12	Be told a decision is waiting	Verifier	Pass
UC-13	Answer "is this real?"	Verifier	Pass
UC-14	Hear what happened after answering	Verifier	Pass
UC-15	Open what was set aside	Recipient	Pass
UC-16	Stop it — check in and close everything	Owner	Pass
UC-17	Read what happened while you were away	Owner	Pass
UC-18	Get back in when the code never arrived	Verifier	Pass
UC-19	Get back in after losing a device	Contact	Pass
UC-20	Leave, export, or close the account	Owner	Pass

REF	USE CASE	ACTOR	RESULT
UC-21	Public surfaces and the legal pages	Visitor	Pass
UC-22	Create a vault	New owner	Pass
UC-23	Get back in after losing the authenticator	Owner	Pass
UC-24	Find out you have been made a helper	Helper	Pass
UC-25	Add things to somebody else's vault	Helper	Pass
UC-26	Suggest a person, and be unable to add them	Helper	Pass
UC-27	Answer a helper's suggestion	Owner	Pass
UC-28	Bring a password manager export in	Owner	Pass
UC-29	Be shown where to start	New owner	Pass
UC-30	Be stopped before firing a release by mistake	Owner	Pass
UC-31	Check it is really them — the verification call	Both	Pass
UC-32	Review what a helper has done on your behalf	Owner	Pass
UC-33	Know how many ways back in you have left	Owner	Pass
UC-34	Meet a page that is missing, or one that broke	Anyone	Pass
UC-35	Judge the product without an account	Visitor	Pass

Two access paths are covered throughout. A contact who has *accepted a standby account* signs in as themselves and nothing secret is transmitted when a release opens — UC-15 was walked that way and the URL carried no token. A contact who cannot sign in — a recipient who never accepted, or a verified verifier holding no passkey and no authenticator — acts using a single-use code, which is why UC-18 and UC-19 show code entry.

UC-01 — Know whether the vault could actually open

Actor	Owner
Goal	Answer one question without reading anything: if something happened tomorrow, would this work?
Expected	A standing statement on every screen. Green only when the plan can actually run; when not, the single fastest next action, not a list of everything imperfect.
Verified	Pass. Reads “could reach both of the things that matter” — counting only items that matter and only verifiers who can actually act. A non-fatal gap (“a second person who can confirm”) is stated without turning the headline red.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

Vault

Import

People

Rules

Triggers

Approvals

Audit

Account

If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach both of the things that matter.

Missing: a second person who can confirm an emergency.

Still to set up

Your plan works, but it rests entirely on one person — and they have no way back in if they lose the device they signed in on. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey. [Go](#)

Vault

4 items · most consequential first

Import CSV

Add item

1 Gmail

Other accounts recover through this one

2 Blue Cross

account

3 Chase Bank

You marked this as one that matters most

4 Home insurance

document

Next: name who could reach these — a vault nobody can open is a vault that does nothing.

UC-01 — the vault, most consequential first, under the standing statement.

UC-02 — Build the circle, and see who does not count

Actor	Owner
Goal	Name who would step in and who would confirm, and understand what is still missing.
Expected	Naming is stated as the first half of two. Each person's line says what is <i>missing</i> , not merely which state they are in. A contact the owner has marked emergency-code-only is never counted as somebody to chase.
Verified	Pass. Four person states on one screen: verified, emergency-code-only, never accepted, and a verified verifier with no fallback. The completeness box counts one outstanding person — the aunt marked code-only is correctly excluded — and no longer claims “nothing would open” while the banner above says the plan works.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

Vault

Import

People

Rules

Triggers

Approvals

Audit

Account

If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach both of the things that matter.

Missing: a second person who can confirm an emergency.

Still to set up

Your plan works, but it rests entirely on one person — and they have no way back in if they lose the device they signed in on. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey. Go

People

Who would step in, who would be asked whether an emergency is real, and what each of them could reach.

Naming someone is the first half. Once they accept, call them and check the phrase matches — until you do, their answer would not count towards opening anything.

Everyone is named — but 1 of them has not been verified yet.

Until you check it is really them, their answer would not count towards opening anything. It is a two-minute call each.

Suggested starting point

Built from what the importance engine already knows. Accept what fits.

Aunt Ruth gets act access to 1 item on an emergency trigger

Root credentials are the reset path for everything else. Without them, nothing else can be recovered.

Accept

Aunt Ruth gets view access to 1 item on an emergency trigger

Critical money and health accounts are what a caregiver reaches for first.

Accept

Who holds what

PERSON	ROLE	ITEMS REACHABLE
Jordan Rivera	partner	3 / 4
Aunt Ruth	caregiver	0 / 4

Who would step in

The people who would receive access. Nothing opens for them until a trigger fires and the people you named confirm it is real — and a person you have not verified cannot receive anything.

Jordan Rivera partner ● Verified — their answer counts

qa-jordan@relay.invalid

If Jordan Rivera loses the device they signed in on, they cannot get back in. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey.

Remove

Verified — undo

Emergency code

Aunt Ruth caregiver ■ Emergency code only

qa-ruth@relay.invalid

Covered by an emergency code only — Aunt Ruth will not count towards your plan, by your choice. Undo

Remove

Emergency code

Name

Email

recipient

Relationship (optional)

Phone (optional)

Add this person

Who confirms it is real

They are asked whether an emergency is real. Their answer only counts once you have checked it is really them. They never see what is inside your vault — only how much, and only when they are asked.

Dr. Alex Chen ● Verified — their answer counts

qa-chen@relay.invalid

If Dr. Alex Chen loses the device they signed in on, they cannot get back in. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey.

Remove

Verified — undo

Emergency code

Pat Morgan ● Has not accepted yet — give them their code

qa-pat@relay.invalid

Give them a code

Remove

Pat Morgan cannot use an account

Emergency code

Name

Email

Phone (optional)

Add a verifier

UC-02 — every person state the product can produce, in one circle.

UC-03 — Decide who can reach what

Actor	Owner
Goal	Give one person scoped access to specific items under a specific kind of emergency.
Expected	Rules read as sentences. Reversible is the default; estate is forced irreversible and the control says so.
Verified	Pass. A rule provisions its trigger, which is why an unused trigger never appears and can never fire.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

Vault

Import

People

Rules

Triggers

Approvals

Audit

Account

If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach both of the things that matter.

Missing: a second person who can confirm an emergency.

Still to set up

Your plan works, but it rests entirely on one person — and they have no way back in if they lose the device they signed in on. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey. [Go](#)

Access Rules

Grant a recipient scoped access to an item under a trigger.

Gmail → Jordan Rivera

emergency · view · reversible

Remove

Chase Bank → Jordan Rivera

emergency · view · reversible

Remove

Blue Cross → Jordan Rivera

emergency · view · reversible

Remove

NEW RULE

Vault item

Select an item...

Recipient

Select a recipient...

Trigger type

emergency

Scope

view

☒ Reversible

Release after

0

days

Add rule

UC-03 — access rules.

UC-04 — Set the conditions

Actor	Owner
Goal	Choose how long Relay waits, and how many people must agree.
Expected	Armed is the resting state. Plain language, no schema vocabulary, no demo controls shown to a non-demo owner.
Verified	Pass. “People who must agree first” rather than “Required confirmations (N)”; the demo simulate control is absent for a real account.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

Vault

Import

People

Rules

Triggers

Approvals

Audit

Account

If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach both of the things that matter.

Missing: a second person who can confirm an emergency.

Still to set up

Your plan works, but it rests entirely on one person — and they have no way back in if they lose the device they signed in on. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey. [Go](#)

Triggers

What would have to happen before anything opens, and how long Relay waits before it starts asking whether you are all right.

Check-in interval (days)

30

Save

I'm fine — check in

YOUR TRIGGERS

Emergency

ARMED

0/1 confirmations

Initiate

People who must agree first:

1

Set

UC-04 — triggers, armed.

UC-05 — Choose someone to help set it up

Actor	Owner
Goal	Let an adult child do the typing without giving them anything they should not have.
Expected	What a helper can and can never do is stated before the button. Candidates are limited to people already named who have accepted.
Verified	Pass. Both lists render; a helper cannot open anything, decide access, touch a release, or add themselves.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

Vault

Import

People

Rules

Triggers

Approvals

Audit

Account

If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach both of the things that matter.

Missing: a second person who can confirm an emergency.

Still to set up

Your plan works, but it rests entirely on one person — and they have no way back in if they lose the device they signed in on. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey. [Go](#)

Things waiting for you

Your helper can add and organise information. Anything that changes **who can reach it** waits for you.

Nothing is waiting. There is no rush and nothing expires.

Someone who helps you set this up

A helper can add and tidy your information so you do not have to do it all yourself.

A helper can:

- add and edit items in your vault
- import a list from elsewhere
- **suggest** people and access rules — which then wait for you

A helper can never:

- open or read anything in your vault
- decide who gets access — every one of those comes to you first
- start, stop or change a release
- add themselves to anything

Jordan Rivera · not active yet

How did you agree to this?

This is kept as a record. It is what makes handing someone this help legitimate rather than simply convenient.

☒ We did it together, in person

You sat with them, showed them this screen, and they said yes.

☐ They signed something on paper

A signed note or form. Say where it is kept, so it can be found later.

☐ They confirmed it themselves, on a device

Only if they genuinely used it. If you clicked for them, say so above instead.

Where is the record kept? (optional)

e.g. signed form in the blue folder

Record it and start

Not now

[Stop them helping](#)

People you could ask

Only people you have already named, who have accepted. If someone is missing, add them to your circle first.

Dr. Alex Chen · qa-chen@relay.invalid

Ask them to help

UC-06 — Record how consent was obtained

Actor	Owner
Goal	Make the delegation legitimate rather than merely convenient.
Expected	Nothing activates until consent is recorded (J3-R2). In-person and paper are offered as <i>peers</i> of the link, because the person being delegated for is the least likely to own a smartphone (J3-R3).
Verified	Pass. Created pending → recorded in person with an evidence note → active. The link option is worded to discourage an owner recording a consent the other person never gave.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

Vault

Import

People

Rules

Triggers

Approvals

Audit

Account

If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach both of the things that matter.

Missing: a second person who can confirm an emergency.

Still to set up

Your plan works, but it rests entirely on one person — and they have no way back in if they lose the device they signed in on. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey. [Go](#)

Things waiting for you

Your helper can add and organise information. Anything that changes **who can reach it** waits for you.

Nothing is waiting. There is no rush and nothing expires.

Someone who helps you set this up

A helper can add and tidy your information so you do not have to do it all yourself.

A helper can:

- add and edit items in your vault
- import a list from elsewhere
- suggest** people and access rules — which then wait for you

A helper can never:

- open or read anything in your vault
- decide who gets access — every one of those comes to you first
- start, stop or change a release
- add themselves to anything

Jordan Rivera · helping you now

[Stop them helping](#)

People you could ask

Only people you have already named, who have accepted. If someone is missing, add them to your circle first.

Dr. Alex Chen · qa-chen@relay.invalid

Ask them to help

UC-06 — active only after the record exists.

UC-07 — Accept a place in someone's plan

Actor	Named contact
Goal	Be recognisable later, without being handed anything now.
Expected	A typed code, never a link that signs you in. Accepting opens nothing.
Verified	Pass. Copy no longer assumes the code arrived by email — delivery is owner-brokered by design.

Enter your invitation code

Someone has named you in their Relay plan.
Type the code they gave you – they may have
read it out, texted it, or written it down.

Code from your email

4KMPQ - 7XR2W

Continue

Nothing is being opened. Accepting only tells them
you have seen it.

UC-08 — Stand by, and see the shape of the grant

Actor	Recipient (standby)
Goal	Know who you are standing by for and roughly what is set aside — never what it is.
Expected	The owner by name . Counts and categories only (J4-R10). Leaving always available.
Verified	Pass. "Margaret Chen", not an email address; "Set aside for you: 3 items" with categories and no titles.

You are on standby

Nothing is open. There is nothing you need to do today.

Margaret Chen

If an emergency is confirmed by the people they trust, what they set aside for you opens. Until then it stays sealed, and it closes again when they check back in.

Set aside for you: 3 items – 1 communication, 1 finance, 1 health. You cannot see what they are, and neither can we.

Nothing open.

Ask Margaret Chen to open it

[Step down from this](#)

Make sure you can get back in

Set up your face, fingerprint or device PIN for this account. Then a new phone will not lock you out, and there is no code to keep somewhere – nothing we could send you that a stranger could imitate. You can do this later.

Set this up

Who would step in for you?

You are covering someone else. The same thing can be set up for your own family, and the first ten items are free.

Start your own plan

UC-08 — standing by. Most of the time this screen says nothing is needed.

UC-09 — Ask them to open it

Actor	Recipient (standby)
Goal	Raise a request when something has happened and no trigger has fired.
Expected	The owner is asked first. Everyone else named is told a request was made, whatever the outcome (J6-R9) — and that is stated <i>before</i> the form, not discovered after. Capped at three in twenty-four hours.
Verified	Pass. Request created against production and reached the owner. Free text is capped, flattened to one line, and any link is removed before it is emailed.

You are on standby

Nothing is open. There is nothing you need to do today.

Margaret Chen

If an emergency is confirmed by the people they trust, what they set aside for you opens. Until then it stays sealed, and it closes again when they check back in.

Set aside for you: 3 items – 1 communication, 1 finance, 1 health. You cannot see what they are, and neither can we.

Nothing open.

Margaret Chen will be asked first.

Everyone else they named is told that you asked, whatever the outcome – that is deliberate, so nobody can quietly reach into someone else's accounts.

What has happened?

An emergency



In your own words

Whoever reads this may have to decide without being able to ask you anything, so say where they are and what you need.

Ask them

Not now

[Step down from this](#)

Make sure you can get back in

Set up your face, fingerprint or device PIN for this account. Then a new phone will not lock you out, and there is no code to keep somewhere – nothing we could send you that a stranger could imitate. You can do this later.

Set this up

Who would step in for you?

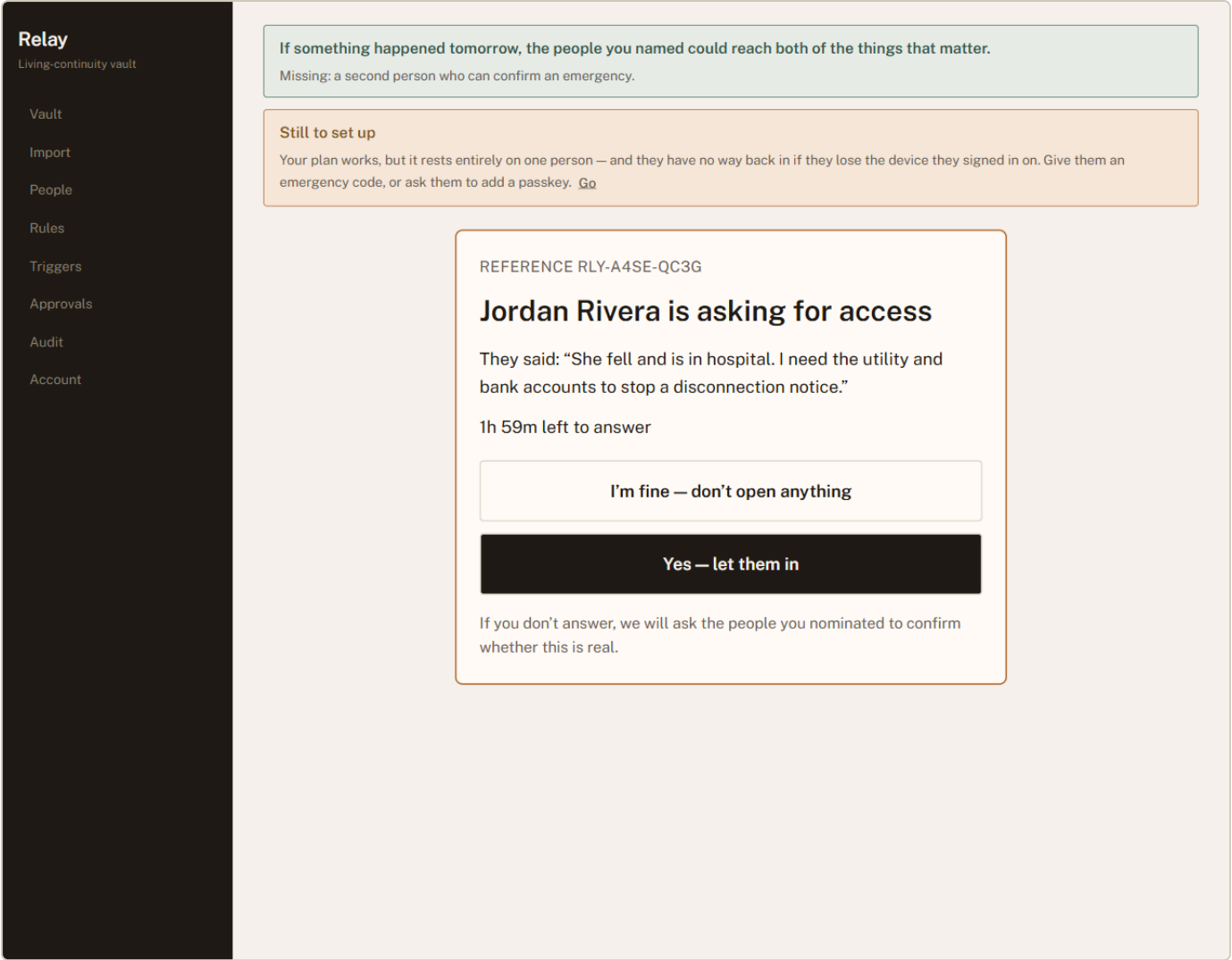
You are covering someone else. The same thing can be set up for your own family, and the first ten items are free.

Start your own plan

UC-09 — the deterrent is stated up front, not afterwards.

UC-10 — Answer a request for access

Actor	Owner
Goal	Say “I’m fine” or “let them in” before anyone else is involved.
Expected	Who asked, in their own words, with a countdown, and a plain statement of what happens if the owner does not answer.
Verified	Pass. “Jordan Rivera is asking for access”, the reason quoted, “1h 58m left to answer”, and both answers offered.



UC-10 — the challenge. Before this walkthrough nothing in the product could produce a request for this screen to show.

UC-11 — Start a release yourself

Actor	Owner
Goal	Open the window deliberately — “I know I am about to be unreachable.”
Expected	Still requires the named people to confirm. Both reversal controls appear, and they are deliberately not equal in weight.
Verified	Pass. Advanced to the confirmable window at 0 of 1 confirmations — nothing opened. Stand down — re-arm is prominent; Cancel permanently is separated and confirms first, so somebody stopping a false alarm at speed cannot retire their whole plan by mistake.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

Vault

Import

People

Rules

Triggers

Approvals

Audit

Account

If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach both of the things that matter.

Missing: a second person who can confirm an emergency.

Still to set up

Your plan works, but it rests entirely on one person — and they have no way back in if they lose the device they signed in on. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey. [Go](#)

Triggers

What would have to happen before anything opens, and how long Relay waits before it starts asking whether you are all right.

Check-in interval (days)

30

Save

I'm fine — check in

YOUR TRIGGERS

Emergency

GRACE

0/1 confirmations

Stand down — re-arm

Cancel permanently

People who must agree first:

1

Set

UC-11 / UC-16 — a release in flight, with both ways to stop it.

UC-12 — Be told a decision is waiting

Actor	Verifier (standby)
Goal	Find the question by visiting the site, with nothing to intercept.
Expected	A verifier who can sign in receives no credential at all — the message tells them to sign in, and the dashboard carries the ask.
Verified	Pass. “They need your answer” with a direct action, and no code was minted for this person.

You are on standby

Something needs your attention below.

Margaret Chen

If an emergency is claimed, you will be asked one question: is this real? You will never see anything inside their vault – not now, and not after you answer.

They need your answer

Answer now

[Step down from this](#)

Make sure you can get back in

Set up your face, fingerprint or device PIN for this account. Then a new phone will not lock you out, and there is no code to keep somewhere – nothing we could send you that a stranger could imitate. You can do this later.

Set this up

Who would step in for you?

You are covering someone else. The same thing can be set up for your own family,

and the first ten items are free.

Start your own plan

UC-12 — pull, not push.

UC-13 — Answer “is this real?”

Actor	Verifier
Goal	Attest that an emergency is genuine, without an account created at decision time and without seeing the vault.
Expected	J7-R3 in order: who is asking, why now , what has been tried, what confirming will and will not cause. Three answers at equal prominence (J7-R6). Scale shown; contents never.
Verified	Pass. “Is this real, for Margaret Chen?” — the vault is named, which it was not before 2026-08-12. “They started this themselves” is derived from how the release began. All three answers now share one visual treatment; until this pass “Yes” was a filled button and “No” an outline.

REFERENCE RLY-8J8S-S8T9

Is this real, for Margaret Chen?

An emergency release has been started on **Margaret Chen's** vault, and you are one of the people they chose to ask.

They started this themselves, before becoming unreachable.

What has happened so far

Relay began asking the people they chose — 8/12/2026, 4:43:30 PM

If you confirm

They get access to **3** items across communication, finance, health.

This can be undone. If it turns out to be a false alarm, access closes again.

0 of 1 needed so far.

What this does not do

You will never see any of their information. Not now, and not after you confirm. You are being asked one question only: whether the situation is genuine.

genuine.

Yes — this is real

No — this is not right

I don't know

"I don't know" is a real answer. We will ask someone else rather than counting it either way.

UC-13 — the decision page. The single highest-stakes screen in the product.

UC-14 — Hear what happened after answering

Actor	Verifier
Goal	Not be left wondering. A verifier who hears nothing back stops answering (J7-R12).
Expected	Immediate closure naming whether it can be reversed, plus the case reference.
Verified	Pass. "Recorded. They can reverse this at any time."

Thank you

Recorded. They can reverse this at any time.

Reference RLY-8J8S-S8T9

UC-15 — Open what was set aside

Actor	Recipient
Goal	Reach the accounts that were assigned, in a usable order.
Expected	Ordered by consequence. Decryption happens in the browser. A contact who accepted signs in as themselves — no token in the URL .
Verified	Pass. Opened from a session with a clean URL; three items in priority order, each revealed only on request.

Your access plan

Work top to bottom — the most consequential items come first.

DO TODAY

1 Gmail [view](#)
login

Reveal

2 Blue Cross [view](#)
account

Reveal

3 Chase Bank [view](#)
account

Reveal

UC-16 — Stop it: check in and close everything

Actor	Owner
Goal	Come back and have it all shut, without undoing anything by hand.
Expected	One action reverses pending, grace and released alike, and names what it closed.
Verified	Pass. "Checked in — emergency re-armed." The released trigger returned to armed and the recipient's access closed.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

Vault

Import

People

Rules

Triggers

Approvals

Audit

Account

If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach both of the things that matter.

Missing: a second person who can confirm an emergency.

Still to set up

Your plan works, but it rests entirely on one person — and they have no way back in if they lose the device they signed in on. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey. [Go](#)

Triggers

What would have to happen before anything opens, and how long Relay waits before it starts asking whether you are all right.

Check-in interval (days)

30

Save

I'm fine — check in

Checked in — emergency re-armed.

YOUR TRIGGERS

Emergency

ARMED

0/1 confirmations

Initiate

People who must agree first:

1

Set

UC-16 — reversal, in one action.

UC-17 — Read what happened while you were away

Actor	Owner
Goal	Find out what actually happened, and be able to check that the answer is trustworthy.
Expected	The story in sentences, above a hash-chained record that cannot be edited. People named, not UUIDs. It must distinguish “somebody looked” from “nothing happened”.
Verified	Pass. “an emergency was raised and Dr. Alex Chen confirmed it was real”; the table names Dr. Alex Chen and Jordan Rivera with the raw ids beneath, and the chain still verifies — names are resolved for display only and never written into the record.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

Vault

Import

People

Rules

Triggers

Approvals

Audit

Account

If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach both of the things that matter.

Missing: a second person who can confirm an emergency.

Still to set up

Your plan works, but it rests entirely on one person — and they have no way back in if they lose the device they signed in on. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey. [Go](#)

What happened

Server: intact Client: — Verify chain

11 entries · append-only, hash-chained.

On 8/12/2026 an emergency was raised and Dr. Alex Chen confirmed it was real. Nothing was opened, and it is closed again.

Closed 8/12/2026, 4:58:37 PM — because you checked back in. Nothing else was reachable, and nothing stayed open.

Every entry

The full record, in the order it happened. Nothing here can be edited or removed — that is what makes the summary above trustworthy rather than merely reassuring.

SEQ	TIME	ACTOR	ACTION	ENTITY	DETAIL	HASH
0	8/12/2026, 4:41:36 PM	You (Margaret Chen) owner:fdb47812-a0d7-4ae1-a9a1-6fe9ff4c113d	delegation_consent_recorded	delegation · edf7a065	▶ view	2af98a8ee87c...
1	8/12/2026, 4:42:30 PM	Jordan Rivera recipient:4d375813-7ff0-4e95-848e-ef16ddc4de77	access_requested	access_request · 45ab3675	▶ view	cca1fe32c961...
2	8/12/2026, 4:43:30 PM	system	release_transition_pending	release_state · fb1a1978	▶ view	7f1bcfdfbdb...
3	8/12/2026, 4:43:31 PM	system	release_transition_grace	release_state · fb1a1978	▶ view	58150763a404...
4	8/12/2026, 4:43:31 PM	You (Margaret Chen) owner:fdb47812-a0d7-4ae1-a9a1-6fe9ff4c113d	trigger_initiated	release_state · fb1a1978	▶ view	8ca195735266...
5	8/12/2026, 4:53:17 PM	Dr. Alex Chen verifier:07e2bd5c-dfab-474d-b01f-c618e1dae72a	verifier_confirmed	release_state · fb1a1978	▶ view	e5c8edf4494e...
6	8/12/2026, 4:53:18 PM	system	release_transition_released	release_state · fb1a1978	▶ view	71e07393735f...
7	8/12/2026, 4:57:38 PM	Jordan Rivera recipient:4d375813-7ff0-4e95-848e-ef16ddc4de77	recipient_dashboard_viewed	release_state · fb1a1978	▶ view	4be50c24bd49...
8	8/12/2026, 4:57:38 PM	Jordan Rivera recipient:4d375813-7ff0-4e95-848e-ef16ddc4de77	recipient_dashboard_viewed	release_state · fb1a1978	▶ view	bc3c3bf829d8...
9	8/12/2026, 4:58:37 PM	system	release_transition_armed	release_state · fb1a1978	▶ view	6bb7241383ad...
10	8/12/2026, 4:58:38 PM	You (Margaret Chen) owner:fdb47812-a0d7-4ae1-a9a1-6fe9ff4c113d	owner_checkin	release_state	▶ view	0cf820d7dd6e...

UC-17 — the record, after a complete incident.

UC-18 — Get back in when the code never arrived

Actor	Verifier
Goal	Answer even though the message never arrived or the code expired.
Expected	Self-service, because the owner may be the person in hospital. Sends to the address on file, never to one typed in.
Verified	Pass. "My code has expired, or never arrived" opens the form. What is sent depends on how the person is set up, so the wording promises what they need rather than "a code".

Enter your code

Someone has asked you to confirm that a situation is genuine. Type the code we sent you.

Code from your email

7 K 4 M - P 2 X W

Continue

My code has expired, or never arrived

You will never be shown anyone's private information — not now, and not after you answer. Relay will never send you a link that signs you in.

UC-19 — Get back in after losing a device

Actor	Any contact
Goal	Act when the usual sign-in is gone — or when there never was one.
Expected	Works once. The owner is told it was used and asked to check it was really them.
Verified	Pass. Copy now names the real alternative when the owner cannot be reached: the others they named can still answer.

Use your emergency code

If you were given a code to keep somewhere safe, type it here. It is the way back in when your usual sign-in is not available.

It works once. The person who gave it to you will be told that you used it, and they will be asked to check it was really you — that is deliberate, and it is what makes a code like this safe to carry.

Your emergency code

XXXX-XXXX-XXXX

Continue

No code? Ask the person who named you, if you can reach them — they can issue a new one. Relay cannot send you one directly, because a code that arrives in an email is a code anyone who reaches that inbox could use. If you cannot reach them, that is what the others they named are for: a decision does not wait on any one person, and the rest of their circle can still answer without you.

UC-20 — Leave, export, or close the account

Actor	Owner
Goal	Take the data out, stop paying, or leave entirely.
Expected	Export decrypted in the browser; cancel without losing the vault; close with the consequences stated in the one colour reserved for what cannot be undone.
Verified	Pass. Name, passkey, recovery codes, subscription, export and closure all present. Leaving is a first-class path, not a support ticket.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

Vault

Import

People

Rules

Triggers

Approvals

Audit

Account

If something happened tomorrow, the people you named could reach both of the things that matter.

Missing: a second person who can confirm an emergency.

Still to set up

Your plan works, but it rests entirely on one person — and they have no way back in if they lose the device they signed in on. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey. [Go](#)

Your account

Take your data out, or close the account.

Your name

This is how you appear to the people you trust. They see it on every message Relay sends on your behalf — including the one that arrives when something has gone wrong, which is the worst possible moment for it to say an email address they do not recognise.

Margaret Chen

Save name

Passkey

Sign in with your face, fingerprint or device PIN — no code to find, and nothing we could email you that a stranger could imitate. Adding one also means a new phone does not lock you out.

Add a passkey

Recovery codes

Relay has no password. If you lose the phone with your authenticator on it, these codes are the only way back in — so if you cannot find the list you were given at signup, get a new one now, while you still can.

Issuing a new list immediately stops the old one working.

Issue new recovery codes

Subscription and billing

Relay is \$119 a year and renews automatically until you cancel. You can cancel at any time from this page. Nothing in your vault is deleted when a subscription ends — it stays exactly as it is, and the free limits apply only to adding more.

Manage or cancel subscription

Export everything

Downloads a readable file containing every item, decrypted here in your browser, plus the people you have designated. Keep it somewhere you would keep a password list — it is not protected once it leaves.

Export my vault

Close this account

Removes your vault, the people you designated, and your access rules. This cannot be undone, and anyone relying on this vault will lose their access immediately.

The tamper-evident event log is kept, exactly as our privacy page says. It holds no secrets — only the record of what happened and when.

Close my account

UC-21 — Public surfaces and the legal pages

Actor	Visitor, and people who never signed up
Goal	Understand the product, and — if somebody named you — find out what that means for you.
Expected	Terms and Privacy each address the population that did not sign up and was merely named.
Verified	Pass. Both live, both carrying those sections. Counsel review under <code>g2-counsel-opinion</code> remains outstanding and this does not substitute for it.

Relay

Sign in

The accounts someone would need, if you could not manage them.

Relay holds them encrypted, opens only what you chose for the person you chose, and only once a real emergency has been confirmed by someone you trust — then closes again when you recover. One price for the whole family, \$119 a year.

I'm caring for a parent

Show me what actually happens

It closes again

Every other way of doing this is a door you open once. Recover, check in, and access ends on its own — which is what makes it safe to set up before you need it.

We cannot read it

Secrets are encrypted in your browser before they reach us. We hold ciphertext, and we are honest on [exactly what we can see](#).

Someone has to say yes

Nothing opens on a timer or a guess. A person you named confirms the situation is real, and never sees anything of yours.

Were you named by someone?

If someone has asked you to be a recipient or a trusted contact, you will have an email with a code in it. Enter it at [relaystandby.com/claim](#). Relay never sends a link that signs you in — if a message claiming to be from us asks you to click one, it is not from us.

Relay — standby access for the people who'll need it.

How it works

Security

Privacy

Terms

UC-22 — Create a vault

Actor	New owner
Goal	Start, without inventing a password.
Expected	Two steps, an authenticator required, and recovery codes issued at the point they can still be saved.
Verified	Pass. The name field shows a live preview of the consequence of leaving it blank — “they will see <i>your email address</i> when we contact them” — which is the same defect that had to be fixed in the standby dashboard, pre-empted at the one moment it can be avoided.

Relay

Create your vault

Two steps. An authenticator app is required — there is no password.

Email address

Your name (optional)

This is how you appear to the people you trust — they will see “your email address” when we contact them.

Continue

Already have an account? [Sign in](#)

UC-23 — Get back in after losing the authenticator

Actor	Owner
Goal	Recover a vault when the phone with the authenticator is gone.
Expected	A recovery code replaces how you sign in and touches nothing inside the vault — and the page says so, because the fear at that moment is that the data is gone.
Verified	Pass. “Your vault contents are untouched — this only replaces how you sign in.”

Get back in

Lost the phone with your authenticator? Use one of the recovery codes you saved when you created your vault. Your vault contents are untouched — this only replaces how you sign in.

Email address

One recovery code

Continue

[Back to sign in](#)

UC-24 — Find out you have been made a helper

Actor	Helper
Goal	Discover the job exists at all.
Expected	Told on a screen they already visit, with the boundary summarised before they go any further.
Verified	Pass. "You are helping Margaret Chen set up" on the standby dashboard. Until this pass nothing told them — an owner could appoint somebody and the person on the other end had no screen, no message and no route they could have guessed.

You are on standby

Nothing is open. There is nothing you need to do today.

Margaret Chen

If an emergency is confirmed by the people they trust, what they set aside for you opens. Until then it stays sealed, and it closes again when they check back in.

Nothing open.

Ask Margaret Chen to open it

[Step down from this](#)

You are helping Margaret Chen set up

You can add things to their vault and suggest people. You cannot open anything, and anything that decides who can reach what goes to them as a question.

Open their setup

Make sure you can get back in

Set up your face, fingerprint or device PIN for this account. Then a new phone will

not lock you out, and there is no code to keep somewhere – nothing we could send you that a stranger could imitate. You can do this later.

Set this up

Who would step in for you?

You are covering someone else. The same thing can be set up for your own family, and the first ten items are free.

Start your own plan

UC-24 — the only way a helper learns.

UC-25 — Add things to somebody else's vault

Actor	Helper
Goal	Do the typing an older parent will not do, without gaining anything they should not have.
Expected	Encrypted in the helper's browser exactly as an owner's is. Sealed on save — a helper cannot read back even their own entry (J3-R4). The boundary is stated above the tools, not discovered by trying.
Verified	Pass. Item saved to another person's vault with delegate provenance recorded and the audit entry attributed to <code>delegate:<id></code> . Probed from the helper's own session: their list returns only their entry — the owner's private item is absent — carries no ciphertext, and a vault with no delegation returns 403 .

Helping Margaret Chen

You can add things to Margaret Chen's vault, and suggest people. Anything that decides **who can reach what** goes to Margaret Chen as a question – you cannot make that call for them.

You cannot open or read anything in their vault – including the things you type here. Once an entry is saved it is sealed to them, so check it before you save it. That is deliberate: it is what makes it safe for them to accept help.

Add something

What is it?

e.g. Electricity account

Kind

Category

login



finance



The details they would need

Account number, sign-in, where the paperwork is – whatever would actually help. This is encrypted before it leaves this page, and you will not be able to read it back.

Saved. It is sealed to them now.

Save to their vault

What you have added

Electricity account · login · finance

Suggest someone who would step in

This does not add them. It goes to Margaret Chen as a question, and only they can say yes.

Their name

Their email

How would you describe them?

recipient



☐ This is me.

Perfectly reasonable to ask – and Margaret Chen will be told clearly that the person suggesting it is the person it is about.

Suggest to Margaret Chen

UC-26 — Suggest a person, and be unable to add them

Actor	Helper
Goal	Say "my brother should be on this" without being able to make it so.
Expected	Everything that decides who can reach what stops and waits for the owner (J3-R6). A helper proposing themselves is offered plainly and labelled on the way past, because hiding it would only mean somebody typing their own name in the field above and nobody noticing.
Verified	Pass. Proposal queued against the helped vault, shown back as "waiting for Margaret Chen", and nothing changed in the circle until she answered.

Helping Margaret Chen

You can add things to Margaret Chen's vault, and suggest people. Anything that decides **who can reach what** goes to Margaret Chen as a question – you cannot make that call for them.

You cannot open or read anything in their vault – including the things you type here. Once an entry is saved it is sealed to them, so check it before you save it. That is deliberate: it is what makes it safe for them to accept help.

Add something

What is it?

e.g. Electricity account

Kind

Category

login



finance



The details they would need

Account number, sign-in, where the paperwork is – whatever would actually help. This is encrypted before it leaves this page, and you will not be able to read it back.

Saved. It is sealed to them now.

Save to their vault

What you have added

Electricity account · login · finance

Suggest someone who would step in

This does not add them. It goes to Margaret Chen as a question, and only they can say yes.

Sent. It is waiting for Margaret Chen to answer.

Their name

Their email

How would you describe them?

recipient



☐ This is me.

Perfectly reasonable to ask – and Margaret Chen will be told clearly that the person suggesting it is the person it is about.

Suggest to Margaret Chen

Waiting for Margaret Chen

Sam Rivera – suggested as someone who would step in

UC-27 — Answer a helper's suggestion

Actor	Owner
Goal	Decide, in plain language, on something somebody proposed on your behalf.
Expected	Approving runs through the same validated path an owner would use — an approved proposal is not a trusted insert.
Verified	Pass. The queue showed the suggestion, the owner approved, and Sam Rivera appeared in the circle as a real recipient. This screen had rendered an empty state since it shipped , waiting on a proposal nothing in the product could make.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

Vault

Import

People

Rules

Triggers

Approvals

Audit

Account

If something happened tomorrow, Jordan Rivera could reach none of the 1 things that matter.

Missing: Electricity account and nobody who can confirm an emergency is real.

Still to set up

No access rules yet, so nothing would be shared even in an emergency. [Go](#)

Things waiting for you

Your helper can add and organise information. Anything that changes **who can reach it** waits for you.

Your helper suggests adding Sam Rivera as a recipient.

Yes, that's fine

No, not this

Saying no changes nothing else. You can decide later.

Someone who helps you set this up

A helper can add and tidy your information so you do not have to do it all yourself.

A helper can:

- add and edit items in your vault
- import a list from elsewhere
- **suggest** people and access rules — which then wait for you

A helper can never:

- open or read anything in your vault
- decide who gets access — every one of those comes to you first
- start, stop or change a release
- add themselves to anything

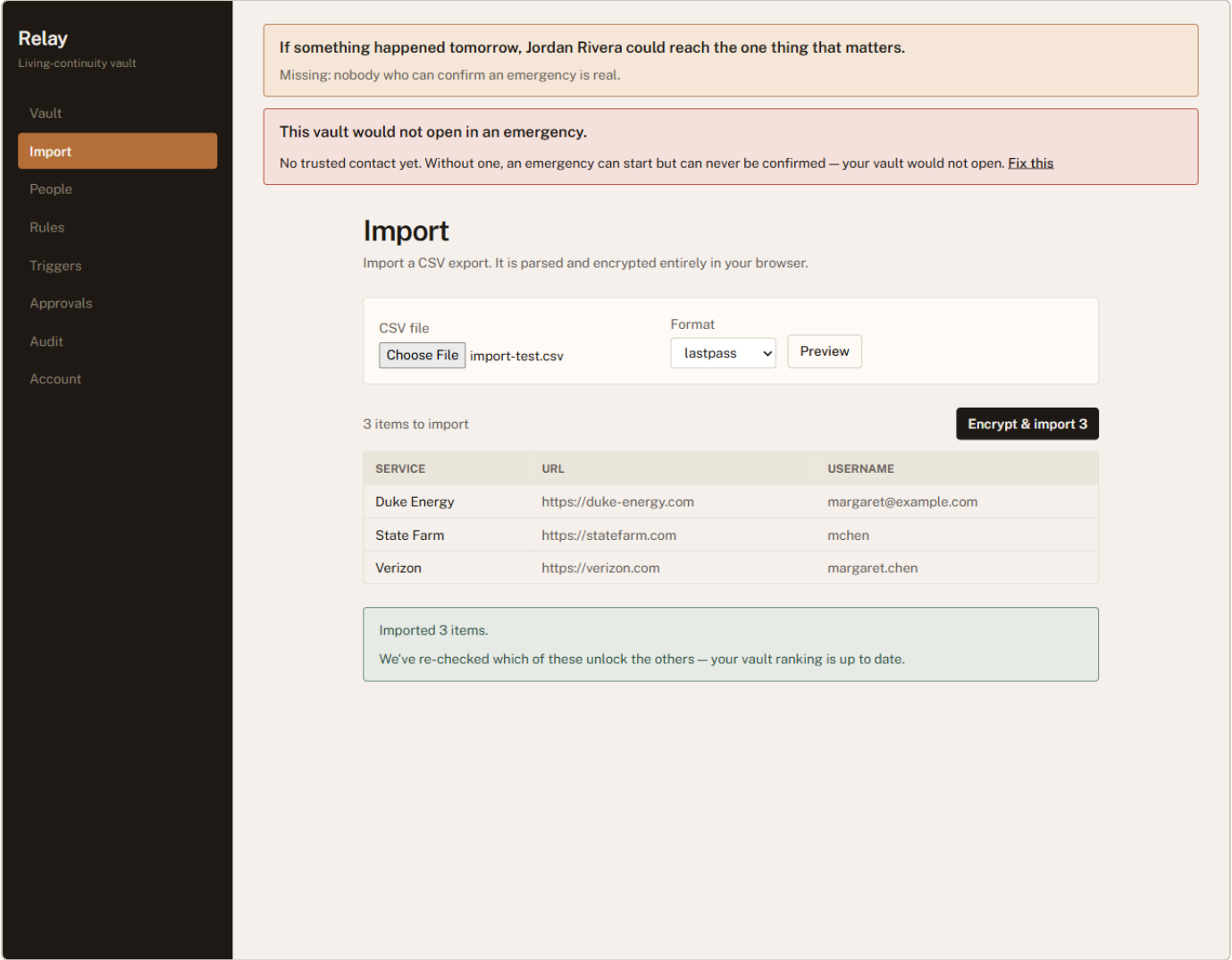
Jordan Rivera · helping you now

[Stop them helping](#)

UC-27 — the queue, filled for the first time.

UC-28 — Bring a password manager export in

Actor	Owner
Goal	Start from what already exists rather than typing it all again.
Expected	Parsed and encrypted entirely in the browser . A preview before anything is written, and the importance engine re-run afterwards so nothing lands silently uncovered.
Verified	Pass . A three-row LastPass export previewed and imported on production; all three appeared in the vault. The preview shows service, URL and username and no passwords — the one screen where a shoulder-surfer would see the whole file at once.



UC-28 — import, after the run.

UC-29 — Be shown where to start

Actor	New owner
Goal	Not face an empty vault and a blank mind.
Expected	The question that produces a useful list — not “add an item”.
Verified	Pass. “If they were hospitalised tomorrow, these are the accounts you would need first.”

Relay

Living-continuity vault

Vault

Import

People

Rules

Triggers

Approvals

Audit

Account

If something happened tomorrow, Jordan Rivera could reach the one thing that matters.

Missing: nobody who can confirm an emergency is real.

This vault would not open in an emergency.

No trusted contact yet. Without one, an emergency can start but can never be confirmed — your vault would not open. [Fix this](#)

Start with what you'd need first

If they were hospitalised tomorrow, these are the accounts you would reach for.

Step 1 of 8

0 saved

Their primary email

The address most other accounts reset through

Which one? (optional)

Gmail, Chase, Blue Cross...

Login details or a note

Encrypted in your browser before it is sent

☒ Other accounts reset through this one

Save and continue

Skip

UC-29 — the first-run prompt.

UC-30 — Be stopped before firing a release by mistake

Actor	Owner
Goal	Not start an emergency with one stray click on a button labelled with a word that does not say what it does.
Expected	The consequence stated, not “are you sure”. Reversible and irreversible triggers get different sentences and different weights; the irreversible one asks the trigger type to be typed , matching what closing an account already demands.
Verified	Pass. “Everyone you named to confirm an emergency will be asked whether this is real... You can stop it at any point by checking in.” Backing out left the trigger ARMED and changed nothing. II This is a precondition on g2-counsel1-opinion , not an improvement — today every selectable trigger is reversible, and the day estate becomes selectable that click is permanent. Since the grace ruling of the same day the estate branch also states the three-day window that follows: with no way to reverse a completed handover, that window is the only chance anyone gets to stop it.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

Vault

Import

People

Rules

Triggers

Approvals

Audit

Account

If something happened tomorrow, Jordan Rivera could reach the one thing that matters.

Missing: nobody who can confirm an emergency is real.

This vault would not open in an emergency.

No trusted contact yet. Without one, an emergency can start but can never be confirmed — your vault would not open. [Fix this](#)

Triggers

What would have to happen before anything opens, and how long Relay waits before it starts asking whether you are all right.

Check-in interval (days)

30

Save

I'm fine — check in

YOUR TRIGGERS

Emergency

ARMED

0/1 confirmations

Everyone you named to confirm an emergency will be asked whether this is real. If enough of them agree, the access you arranged opens. You can stop it at any point by checking in.

Yes — ask them now

Not yet

People who must agree first:

1

Set

UC-30 — the confirmation.

UC-31 — Check it is really them

Actor	Owner and contact, together, on the phone
Goal	Establish that the person who accepted the invitation is the person who was meant to.
Expected	Four words derived from the binding, shown to both sides. The owner reads theirs aloud; the contact confirms theirs match. A mismatch means somebody else opened the invitation, and both screens say what to do about it.
Verified	Pass. Both screens read <code>granite forest mitten granite</code> . The owner pressed “The words matched”, the person flipped to verified, and readiness moved from “ <i>your plan cannot run yet</i> ” to executable.

This is the most consequential use case in the product, and until 2026-08-12 it could not be performed at all. The owner’s screen has always said “They see the same four words on their own screen” — and nothing showed them to the contact. The owner was being asked to make a *comparison the other side could not take part in*, and a person asked “do these match?” while holding nothing says yes. Everything downstream rests on it: since §4.3, only a **confirmed** person’s answer counts towards opening anything.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

Vault

Import

People

Rules

Triggers

Approvals

Audit

Account

If something happened tomorrow, Jordan Rivera could reach the one thing that matters.

Missing: a second person who can confirm an emergency.

Your plan cannot run yet

Confirm a recipient who has already claimed. Verifiers could agree, but nobody is set up to receive anything. [Go to your circle](#)

Still to set up

Your plan works, but it rests entirely on one person — and they have no way back in if they lose the device they signed in on. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey. [Go](#)

People

Who would step in, who would be asked whether an emergency is real, and what each of them could reach.

Naming someone is the first half. Once they accept, call them and check the phrase matches — until you do, their answer would not count towards opening anything.

Everyone is named — but 1 of them has not been verified yet.

Until you check it is really them, their answer would not count towards opening anything. It is a two-minute call each.

Suggested starting point

Built from what the importance engine already knows. Accept what fits.

Jordan Rivera gets act access to 1 item on an emergency trigger

Root credentials are the reset path for everything else. Without them, nothing else can be recovered.

Accept

Who holds what

PERSON	ROLE	ITEMS REACHABLE
Jordan Rivera	partner	1 / 1

Who would step in

The people who would receive access. Nothing opens for them until a trigger fires and the people you named confirm it is real — and a person you have not verified cannot receive anything.

Jordan Rivera partner Accepted — not yet verified, so their answer would not count

ra-jordan@relay.invalid

If Jordan Rivera loses the device they signed in on, they cannot get back in. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey.

Call Jordan Rivera and read this out

granite forest mitten granite

They see the same four words on their own screen. Speaking to them is the point — it is the one channel nobody else can reach, and it is what tells you the person who accepted is the person you meant.

The words matched

They did not match

Not now

Remove

[Emergency code](#)

Name

Email

recipient

Relationship (optional)

Phone (optional)

Add this person

Who confirms it is real

They are asked whether an emergency is real. Their answer only counts once you have checked it is really them. They never see what is inside your vault — only how much, and only when they are asked.

Dr. Alex Chen Verified — their answer counts

ra-chen@relay.invalid

If Dr. Alex Chen loses the device they signed in on, they cannot get back in. Give them an emergency code, or ask them to add a passkey.

[Verified — undo](#)

[Emergency code](#)

Remove

Name

Email

Phone (optional)

Add a verifier

UC-31 — the owner's side: call them and read this out.

You are on standby

Nothing is open. There is nothing you need to do today.

Margaret Chen

If an emergency is confirmed by the people they trust, what they set aside for you opens. Until then it stays sealed, and it closes again when they check back in.

Margaret Chen will call you and read out four words. These are yours – they should be the same.

**granite forest mitten
granite**

If they do not match, say so and stop – it means somebody else opened the invitation meant for you. Nothing is lost; they can start again on a channel you both trust.

Set aside for you: 1 item – 1 communication. You cannot see what they are, and neither can we.

Nothing open.

Ask Margaret Chen to open it

[Step down from this](#)

Make sure you can get back in

Set up your face, fingerprint or device PIN for this account. Then a new phone will not lock you out, and there is no code to keep somewhere – nothing we could send you that a stranger could imitate. You can do this later.

Set this up

Who would step in for you?

You are covering someone else. The same thing can be set up for your own family, and the first ten items are free.

Start your own plan

UC-31 — the contact's side, which did not exist before, including what to do when the words do **not** match.

UC-32 — Review what a helper has done on your behalf

Actor	Owner
Goal	Know what somebody with setup rights actually did, without reading a raw log.
Expected	J3-R8. Plain language, derived from the audit chain rather than a second log that could drift from it, and placed beside the control that removes them — the evidence belongs next to the decision it informs.
Verified	Pass. A helper added an item and suggested a person; the owner saw “Added something to your vault” and “Suggested somebody who would step in”. In the record itself the actor now reads “Jordan Rivera (helping you)” with the raw id beneath and the chain still intact — delegates were the one actor type without a name until this pass.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

Vault

Import

People

Rules

Triggers

Approvals

Audit

Account

If something happened tomorrow, Jordan Rivera could reach none of the 1 things that matter.

Missing: Water rates and nobody who can confirm an emergency is real.

Still to set up

No access rules yet, so nothing would be shared even in an emergency. [Go](#)

Things waiting for you

Your helper can add and organise information. Anything that changes **who can reach it** waits for you.

Your helper suggests adding Sam Rivera as a recipient.

Yes, that's fine

No, not this

Saying no changes nothing else. You can decide later.

Someone who helps you set this up

A helper can add and tidy your information so you do not have to do it all yourself.

A helper can:

- add and edit items in your vault
- import a list from elsewhere
- suggest** people and access rules — which then wait for you

A helper can never:

- open or read anything in your vault
- decide who gets access — every one of those comes to you first
- start, stop or change a release
- add themselves to anything

Jordan Rivera · helping you now

What they have done

Added something to your vault — 8/12/2026, 8:36:34 PM

Suggested somebody who would step in — 8/12/2026, 8:36:41 PM

[Stop them helping](#)

UC-32 — what they did, beside “Stop them helping”.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

Vault

Import

People

Rules

Triggers

Approvals

Audit

Account

If something happened tomorrow, Jordan Rivera could reach none of the 1 things that matter.

Missing: Water rates and nobody who can confirm an emergency is real.

Still to set up

No access rules yet, so nothing would be shared even in an emergency. [Go](#)

What happened

2 entries · append-only, hash-chained.

Server: intact Client: — Verify chain

Nothing has ever been opened.

No emergency has been raised on your vault. If one ever is, what happened will be written here in plain words — who confirmed it, what was opened, and when it closed again.

Every entry

The full record, in the order it happened. Nothing here can be edited or removed — that is what makes the summary above trustworthy rather than merely reassuring.

SEQ	TIME	ACTOR	ACTION	ENTITY	DETAIL	HASH
0	8/12/2026, 8:36:34 PM	Jordan Rivera (helping you) delegate:62f57701-393b-4eee-8a85-423d0fbb394b	vault_item_created	vault_item · d91e3771	▶ view	1fc012b51e12...
1	8/12/2026, 8:36:41 PM	Jordan Rivera (helping you) delegate:62f57701-393b-4eee-8a85-423d0fbb394b	approval_requested	approval · 025ec3d5	▶ view	9d2cd4d049d6...

UC-32 — and in the tamper-evident record, named rather than a UUID.

UC-33 — Know how many ways back in you have left

Actor	Owner
Goal	Not discover you are out of recovery codes at the moment you need one.
Expected	A count, never a code — they are stored as hashes and readable exactly once, at issue. Coloured by how much room is left, because “1 left” in the same grey as everything else is a fact nobody acts on.
Verified	Pass. Four issued with one spent read “You have 3 left.” A silent cliff until this pass: codes are consumed one per use and are the only way back when the authenticator is gone, and the product said nothing as the sheet ran down.

Relay

Living-continuity vault

Vault

Import

People

Rules

Triggers

Approvals

Audit

Account

If something happened tomorrow, Jordan Rivera could reach none of the 1 things that matter.

Missing: Water rates and nobody who can confirm an emergency is real.

Still to set up

No access rules yet, so nothing would be shared even in an emergency. [Go](#)

Your account

Take your data out, or close the account.

Your name

This is how you appear to the people you trust. They see it on every message Relay sends on your behalf — including the one that arrives when something has gone wrong, which is the worst possible moment for it to say an email address they do not recognise.

Save name

Passkey

Sign in with your face, fingerprint or device PIN — no code to find, and nothing we could email you that a stranger could imitate. Adding one also means a new phone does not lock you out.

Add a passkey

Recovery codes

Relay has no password. If you lose the phone with your authenticator on it, these codes are the only way back in — so if you cannot find the list you were given at signup, get a new one now, while you still can.

Issuing a new list immediately stops the old one working.

You have 3 left.

Issue new recovery codes

Subscription and billing

Relay is \$119 a year and renews automatically until you cancel. You can cancel at any time from this page. Nothing in your vault is deleted when a subscription ends — it stays exactly as it is, and the free limits apply only to adding more.

Manage or cancel subscription

Export everything

Downloads a readable file containing every item, decrypted here in your browser, plus the people you have designated. Keep it somewhere you would keep a password list — it is not protected once it leaves.

Export my vault

Close this account

Removes your vault, the people you designated, and your access rules. This cannot be undone, and anyone relying on this vault will lose their access immediately.

The tamper-evident event log is kept, exactly as our privacy page says. It holds no secrets — only the record of what happened and when.

Close my account

UC-33 — the account screen.

UC-34 — Meet a page that is missing, or one that broke

Actor	Anyone — most likely a contact who mistyped an address read to them over the phone
Goal	Not be told, in a stack-shaped default page, that something is wrong with them.
Expected	Written for the contact , not the owner: one of the two readers may be in a hospital corridor. Leads with the fear — nothing lost, nothing opened — and names the three places somebody was probably trying to reach rather than offering a dashboard they do not have.
Verified	Pass. The 404 serves the product's voice; Next's bare default is gone. A failure also reports itself : the digest, the path and the mode reach the operator, and the error message never does — it could carry vault content. Live-proved on production, including that a query string is stripped before it can copy a live ticket into an email.

There is nothing at this address

Most likely a letter is off somewhere. Nothing is broken and nothing has been lost.

If somebody sent you here, you probably want one of these:

Somebody gave me a code to accept a place

I was asked to confirm whether something is real

I was told something was opened for me

I have my own vault and want to sign in

Relay never sends a link that signs you in, so if you arrived from a message promising that, it was not from us.

UC-35 — Judge the product without an account

Actor	Visitor, deciding whether this is worth signing up for
Goal	See what an owner sees — and what the server sees — before handing anything over.
Expected	Read-only, no account, no writes. Four stops: the vault ranked by consequence, the complete server-side record for one item, the release state machine, and the hash-chained audit trail. It must show only what a visitor can actually buy .
Verified	Pass. The chain shown in the fourth stop is computed and verified with the production primitives, so its “intact” chip is the real verifier result rather than a decoration. Two recipients under two triggers, so scoped access is shown to differ by person <i>and</i> by condition. No horizontal overflow and no undersized targets at 1280 or 390.

● **It was selling something the Terms disclaim, and this is the second time that shipped.** Four of the eight sample items routed to an `estate` trigger — excluded from `USER_SELECTABLE_TRIGGER_TYPES` pending `g2-counsel-opinion`, while `/terms` says in as many words that “Estate and inheritance functionality is not offered.” The identical contradiction had already been closed once in `/rules`, which used to render its dropdown from the unfiltered list; that fix reached the dropdown and nothing connected it to the tour.

Retargeted to a **caregiver arc** — an adult child managing a parent’s affairs, which is the wedge the product is sold on and a trigger a visitor can choose today. The same false offer appeared twice more on `/caregivers` and once in the tour’s own prose (“Estate releases, by contrast, are permanent by design”), which survived the first pass because grepping the `ITEMS` never reached the `COPY`.

Three guards now hold it: every demo item must use a selectable trigger, the prose must mention no unbuyable trigger, and the tour must keep more than one recipient and more than one trigger — so a future fix cannot quietly flatten the thing the table exists to demonstrate.

🏆 Winner — Most Impactful · H0: Hack the Zero Stack with Vercel and AWS Databases

See what an owner sees.

A read-only tour with sample data — no account needed. Four stops: the vault, what the server actually stores, the release state machine, and the tamper-evident audit trail.

Demo environment with fictional sample data — nothing here is a real secret, and nothing you do on this page writes anywhere.

01 · The vault

Ranked by what matters in a crisis

The importance engine scores every item from metadata alone — it never sees a secret. The top of the list is almost always the primary email: the key that unlocks most password resets.

ITEM	CATEGORY	IMPORTANCE	GOES TO	TRIGGER
Primary email — jordan@example.com	Email	0.97	Sam (spouse)	emergency
Password manager master vault	Credentials	0.94	Sam (spouse)	emergency
Checking & bill-pay account	Banking	0.88	Sam (spouse)	emergency
Health & home insurance policies	Insurance	0.81	Alex (daughter)	caregiver
Letter of instruction — care wishes	Instructions	0.78	Alex (daughter)	caregiver
Mortgage & deed documents	Documents	0.66	Alex (daughter)	caregiver
Utilities & household subscriptions	Subscriptions	0.41	Sam (spouse)	emergency
Family photo archive location + key	Documents	0.35	Alex (daughter)	caregiver

02 · Zero-knowledge storage

This is everything the server has

Encryption happens in the browser: a per-item AES-GCM-256 data key encrypts the secret, then AWS KMS wraps that key. The row below is the complete server-side record for “Primary email — jordan@example.com” — ciphertext is all there is to steal.

```
algorithm
AES-GCM-256 (per-item data key, generated in the browser)

ciphertext
q9XoZ0m4vGk7T2cRt8yHfBqUj3nHsA1dLxPvC6eKZrM5wYhN0iJgD4bTQXm8SoEa7Vf12uHcRpKAYG9jNtW1zH6dSBoLqIXUvhPrEnT3JgYwCk5m0e...

wrapped_data_key
AQIDAHhwZk1Nb2NrS2V5Rm9yRGVtb1RvdXJ3Pbmx5AAAAFjB8B8gkqhkiG9w0BBwagbzBtAgEAMGgGCSqGSIb3DQEHATAeBg1ghkgBZQMEAS4wEQQM...

iv                                kms_key
5c2Fw1nJ9xTQb0Vd                alias/relay-h0-mvp

stored columns: ciphertext · wrapped_data_key · iv · kms_key_id · metadata — plaintext is not a column
```

03 · The release state machine

One verified emergency, step by step

Every transition is a strongly-consistent compare-and-set on Aurora DSQ — shown under each step. Owner, verifiers, and the scheduler can all act at once and the machine still advances exactly once. If retries ever exhaust, the row lands back in ARMED.

ARMED

2026-06-27T14:02:11Z

Default-safe. Nothing is accessible.

The owner checks in on schedule; recipients hold links that resolve to nothing. ARMED is the state the system falls back to whenever anything is uncertain — including when concurrent writes exhaust their retries.

```
state = 'armed', version = 3
```

PENDING 2026-06-27T14:02:36Z

An emergency trigger fires.

A missed check-in (or a manual emergency) advances the machine. The transition is a strongly-consistent compare-and-set on Aurora DSQL — it succeeds exactly once, no matter how many actors race.

```
UPDATE release_state SET state='pending', version=version+1 WHERE id=$1 AND state='armed' AND version=$2
```

GRACE 2026-06-27T14:02:47Z

Grace window opens; verifiers are asked.

The owner is notified and can cancel with one check-in. Meanwhile N-of-M trusted verifiers independently confirm the emergency is real. No single person — not even a verifier — can force a release alone.

```
UPDATE release_state SET state='grace', grace_ends_at=$3 WHERE id=$1 AND state='pending' AND version=$2
```

RELEASED 2026-06-27T14:03:12Z

Scoped access opens — and stays reversible.

Recipients can now decrypt only the items they were granted. When the owner recovers and checks in, the version bump instantly invalidates every recipient token and the vault re-ARMs — everything Relay offers today is reversible in exactly this way.

```
UPDATE release_state SET state='released', released_at=now() WHERE id=$1 AND state='grace' AND version=$2
```

04 · The audit trail

Append-only, hash-chained, tamper-evident ✓ chain intact

Each entry's hash is SHA-256 of the previous hash plus the entry itself, anchored at a genesis of 64 zeros. This chain isn't an illustration — it's computed and verified by the same code that runs in production. Edit any line and the chip above flips red.

#1	owner.signin owner	0000000000_000000 → 29cc7a0707_4748b4
	TOTP sign-in from a recognized device	
#2	vault.item_created owner	29cc7a0707_4748b4 → 183bb6fd81_654a6e
	Item "Primary email" stored (ciphertext + wrapped key only)	
#3	rules.granted owner	183bb6fd81_654a6e → dfa666ec24_dfb157
	Sam granted "Primary email" under the emergency trigger	
#4	trigger.armed owner	dfa666ec24_dfb157 → 589f5a8bd0_499758
	Emergency trigger armed — 2 verifiers, 1 confirmation required	
#5	release.pending system	589f5a8bd0_499758 → 47625e01ee_4c8026
	Missed check-in advanced ARMED → PENDING (CAS, version 3 → 4)	
#6	release.grace_opened system	47625e01ee_4c8026 → f30a723be3_99908e
	Grace window opened; owner and verifiers notified	
#7	verifier.confirmed verifier:alex	f30a723be3_99908e → 75493a9829_93c173
	Verifier confirmation 1 of 1 received	
#8	release.released system	75493a9829_93c173 → 81efd951e9_c7f57d
	GRACE → RELEASED (CAS); recipient tokens now resolve	
#9	access.decrypted recipient:sam	81efd951e9_c7f57d → 3010575024_c68f1f
	Recipient unwrapped "Primary email" via KMS (scoped token)	

#10 `release.rearmed` owner

Owner check-in re-armed the vault; version bump revoked all recipient tokens

3010575024_c68f1f →
1d75136000_28f396

Caring for an aging parent right now?

Everything above was built for one moment in particular: the call comes, and suddenly you need their bank, their insurance portal, their email — and you need that access to end when the crisis does.

[See Relay for caregivers →](#)

Want the full story?

Two minutes of video shows the live system doing everything above — including a multi-region failover.

[Watch the demo video](#)

[Devpost submission](#)

[Source on GitHub](#)

[← Back to the front page](#)

UC-35 — relaystandby.com/demo, after the retarget. Sam (spouse) on `emergency`, Alex (daughter) on `caregiver`, and nothing on offer that is not for sale.

Stated coverage limits

What this document does **not** evidence, said plainly rather than left to be assumed.

SURFACE	STATUS
/import	✔ Walked 2026-08-12 — UC-28.
/start	✔ Photographed 2026-08-12 — UC-29.
A helper actually helping	✔ Built and walked 2026-08-12 — UC-24 to UC-27. Was the one journey this document could not evidence.
Policy proposals	✔ Resolved by removal 2026-08-12. policies:propose was granted to every helper, offered by nothing, and could not be applied on approval — an owner could be told a suggestion was granted and have nothing change. Dropped rather than built, because a policy joins an item to a recipient and a helper can see neither: building it honestly would mean showing them the owner's circle. An unapplicable approval can now no longer be approved at all, only rejected.
Helper import	import:run is granted and there is no helper-facing import screen. Additive once wanted.
Estate release	Deliberately unreachable — estate is excluded from user-selectable triggers pending g2-counsel-opinion .